

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

INTELLIGENCE MEMORANDUM

DATE: January 26th, 2026

FROM: Megan Fife

SOURCES:

<https://apnews.com/article/iran-protests-araghchi-trump-threat-crackdown-299375ebfd004dd6098c77a6bb8079a5>

<https://www.tehrantimes.com/news/522988/Beyond-Trump-The-structural-roots-of-the-conflict-with-Iran>

TOPIC: Anti-Regime Protests in Iran

ISSUE: The Iranian government is killing protestors who rioted in response to recent economic currency fluctuations and general governmental instability. President Trump states a heavy U.S. militaristic response would occur.

BACKGROUND: The United States has a history of intervening in Iranian governmental affairs with the 1953 coup leading to the 1979 Iranian revolution which came about in response to external western domination. The killing of innocents who are protesting peacefully affects UN members, especially the U.S., as they feel the pressure to respond to this humanitarian issue. President Trump has explicitly stated that a US implied militaristic response would occur were this event to happen. Official death tolls are at 3,117 according to official Iranian governmental reports, but U.S. based agencies estimate 4,000 or more. The internet in Iran was shut off by the government to restrict protestors abilities to congregate since January 8th and has limited news reporters' access in the region as well. Current strikes on Iranian nuclear facilities by the U.S. and the 12-day war have increased the conversation on U.S. militaristic involvement in the area as well. F-15E Strike Eagles have arrived in the Middle East, and the USS Abraham Lincoln has been relocated from the pacific and has the ability of reaching the region within a few days.

ANALYSIS: The Iranian government and its people are fighting for sovereignty. The people feel the shortcomings of their government in their direct lives and desire change. The Tehran Times implores its audience to look deeper into the cause of American involvement into Iranian affairs using emotional language to direct their hardships to the bigger picture, U.S. involvement. The increase of U.S. militaristic presence in the region

means the goals of both parties will not be reached but the U.S. has justification to intervene. This is the cycle of the region, and it will not be broken by the U.S.